

Help us help you

Last month, Digit did something unconventional, and I've got a lot of feedback about it. Ranging from abuse to high praise, and from selling out in a few areas of India, to Digit's worst showing yet in more conservative parts, it's clear that Digit made a statement, one which we thought was necessary, and which most of you agreed with. I thank you for that.

Coming to this issue, with Diwali around the corner, and the fact that you will soon start getting bombarded with offers left, right and centre, we've tried to time this two part series with a purpose. Although the festival of lights is in November, Team Digit found that many purchases are made in the month leading up to Diwali. If not purchases, then people do decide what they want to buy well in advance. For us, this seemed the perfect time to do our bit in helping you save money.

This month's cover story was born from a very simple question, "How can we get readers to Buy Smarter?" And no, it's not good enough, or possible even, to just test every product that's sold in India. Factor in all of the varying prices across regions, and you understand how hard it is to decide for you, "Here, buy this!"

Of course, all those problems are what we try and overcome when we test products in our Bazaar section, or compare them in our comparison tests, and no, we're not going to stop doing that. However, after last month's cover story, we did feel like we needed to do more than just test and provide you with answers. What we really want is for India to start asking the right questions, for every buyer to be able to make up his or her own mind by arming them with the right information. No one knows your needs better than yourself, and if we can show you what's important and what's not, help demystify jargon, and give you little inside scoops into why things are sold a certain way... well, we think it's the best way to accomplish our goal of helping you to buy smarter.

Of course, we also have a hidden agenda, but it's not sinister or evil, don't worry. What we want is to do our bit to help improve the Indian technology market by giving it the kick in the backside it needs from time to time, instead of just lauding its accomplishments.

And of course we will not be able to do any of that unless you help us to.

The very first thing we need your help with is to take part in our annual Icons of Trust survey. Available at www.thinkdigit.com/trust this is a survey we conduct in order to praise the brands that you report back to us as offering great products and even better customer service experiences. This will be published in parts in upcoming issues, and will also be made available online on thinkdigit.com for everyone (brands and readers) to see. We're hoping this annual survey will help millions of Indians choose the right brand, based on a brand's past track record. It will also help brands that are lagging behind in terms of the technology used in their products, the services they offer, or just a failure to impress upon buyers such as yourself. We also request you to share the link with as many friends as you have via Facebook, email or otherwise, because we want feedback not just from our readers, but from anyone who has bought a technology product.

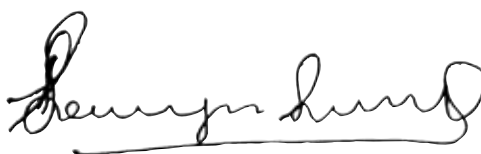
The second thing we need your help with is awareness. We would like you to read this month's cover story, and use the knowledge you gain to not just help yourself, but also friends and relatives who are buying products this festival season (or even in the future) buy smarter. Another easy way to accomplish this is to give your copy of the magazine to someone who is going out to buy a product from amongst the categories we've covered, so that they can use it to arm themselves with the right knowledge to buy the best product they can afford.

As always, I also welcome feedback from you on more ways Digit can help, and encourage readers who have had a torrid time with customer service to write in to me, and someone from Team Digit will try and help you get some justice. Also, if you just want some buying advice that this issue couldn't provide you with, write in to agent001@thinkdigit.com. 



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Liked or hated this column?
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